Learn to write the Hebrew letters

The letters are in **teaching order**, not alphabet order: Shin and Bet first, then the letters of lessons 1 to 10 of the course, then the rest. The vowel kamatz and your first syllables come right after the first nine letters. Hebrew is written and read from **right to left**. In every practice row, the first (black) model letter is at the **right**: trace it, then keep writing to the left. The letters fade from solid grey, to dotted, to empty, so you finish by writing on your own.

How to use this workbook

1. Look at the stroke-order page at the start of each section. The numbers show the order; the arrow shows where each stroke ends.
2. In each row, trace the grey and dotted letters, then fill the empty space.
3. Tick the box at the left of the row when you can write that letter **3 times without looking** at the model.
4. Colour in one circle in the progress chart below each time you do that (three circles per letter).

DRAFT: stroke order not yet reviewed by a native teacher. The numbered strokes in this workbook were computed from fonts and checked only against one outside reference; if your teacher shows a different order, follow your teacher. Cursive shapes come from the font Gveret Levin (Israeli handwriting style); real handwriting also joins and varies.

My progress (27 letters, in teaching order)

ה 9. He ○○○	א 8. Alef ○○○	י 7. Yod ○○○	ו 6. Vav ○○○	ם 5. Mem sofit ○○○	ל 4. Lamed ○○○	ת 3. Tav ○○○	ב 2. Bet ○○○	ש 1. Shin ○○○
ח 18. Chet ○○○	ף 17. Pe sofit ○○○	פ 16. Pe ○○○	ן 15. Nun sofit ○○○	נ 14. Nun ○○○	ך 13. Kaf sofit ○○○	כ 12. Kaf ○○○	מ 11. Mem ○○○	ר 10. Resh ○○○
ק 27. Qof ○○○	ץ 26. Tsadi sofit ○○○	צ 25. Tsadi ○○○	ט 24. Tet ○○○	ז 23. Zayin ○○○	ס 22. Samekh ○○○	ע 21. Ayin ○○○	ח 20. Gimel ○○○	ד 19. Dalet ○○○

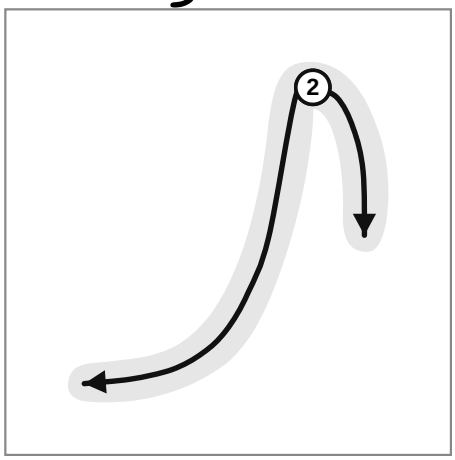
Memory hooks (DRAFT): the italic line on each row is a sound-alike memory trick, not the history of the letter, and has not been checked by a Hebrew teacher.

* The values 500-900 for the five final (sofit) letters are a widely used convention, not confirmed by a source consulted here. Gematria = the number value of a letter. Letters with two sounds (Bet/Vet, Kaf/Khaf, Pe/Fe, Shin/Sin) have two rows; the row marked "b" is the second sound.

Letters 1-9: Shin, Bet, Tav, Lamed, Final Mem, Vav, Yod, Alef, He

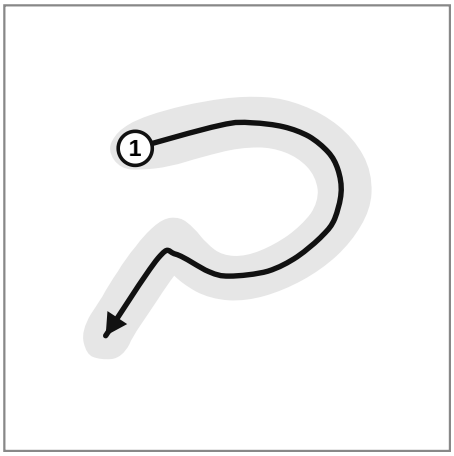
Circle with a number = where each stroke starts; arrowhead = where it ends. **Draft order, not teacher-reviewed.**

Tav



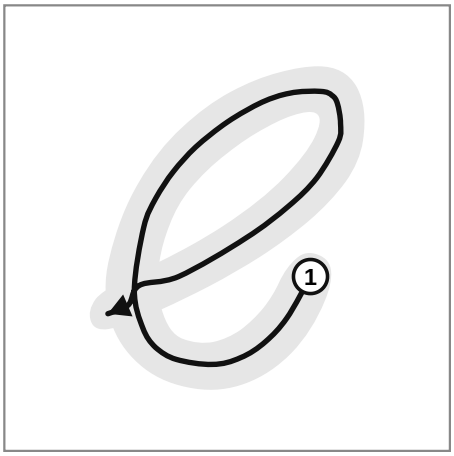
2 strokes

Bet



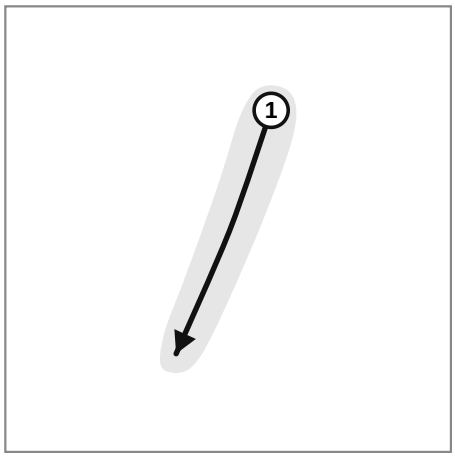
1 stroke

Shin



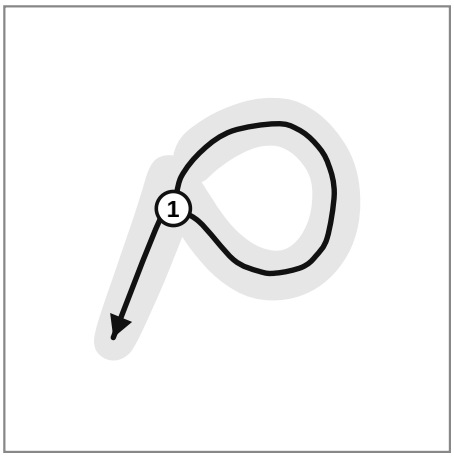
1 stroke

Vav



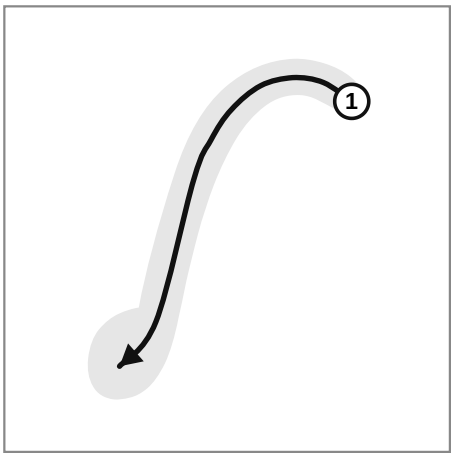
1 stroke

Mem sofit



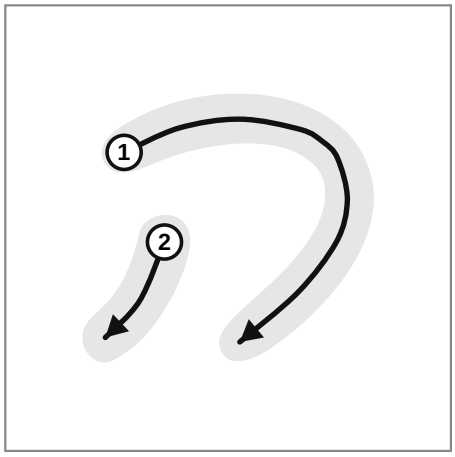
1 stroke

Lamed



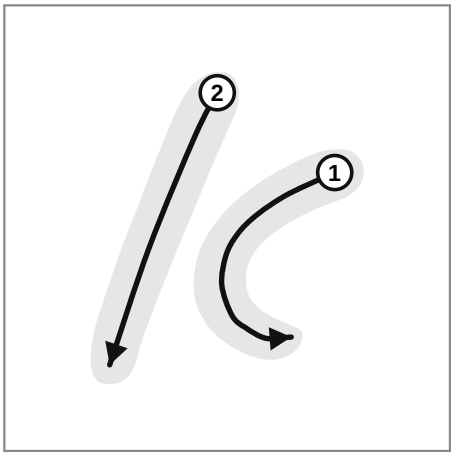
1 stroke

He



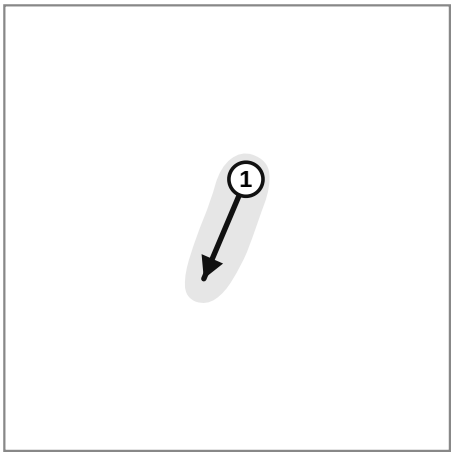
2 strokes

Alef



2 strokes

Yod



1 stroke

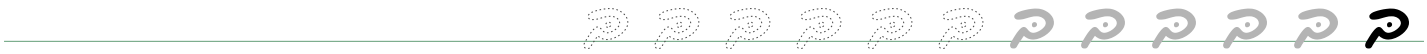
☐ **1** Shin (300) *three flames: Shhh; dot on the left = Sin, a Sun: Sss* /ʃ/



☐ **1b** Sin (300) *Shin with the dot on the left: a Sun on the left, Sss* /s/



☐ **2** Bet (2) *a Bungalow with a Ball inside: B (no ball = Vacant = V)* /b/



☐ **2b** Vet (2) *Bet's house with no ball: Vacant, V* /v/



☐ **3** Tav (400) *a Table with a Toe tapping 'todah': T, the last letter* /t/



☐ **4** Lamed (30) *a tall Lamp post lighting everyone below: L for Learn* /l/



☐ **5** Mem sofit (600*) *the tent zipped shut at the end of the word: m* /m/



☐ **6** Vav (6) *a Vine hanging straight down, humming vvv; hooks 'and'* /v/



☐ **7** Yod (10) *a Yo-yo bead floating at the top: the tiniest letter, Y* /j/



☐ **8** Alef (1) *silent mime in a handstand; the vowel does the talking* /ʔ/

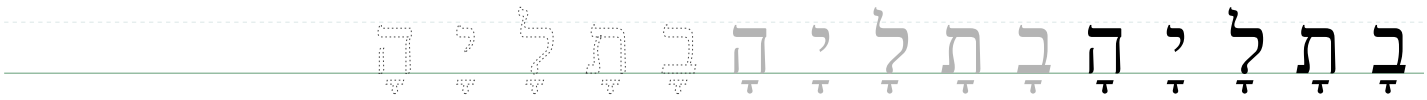


☐ **9** He (5) *a Hut with a Hole: Holler 'Hey!' through the gap* /h/

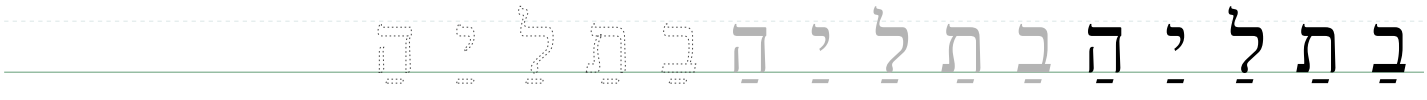


A consonant plus a vowel mark makes a syllable. Write the vowel marks small and exactly under (or above) the letter. Models use the print font so the marks are clear.

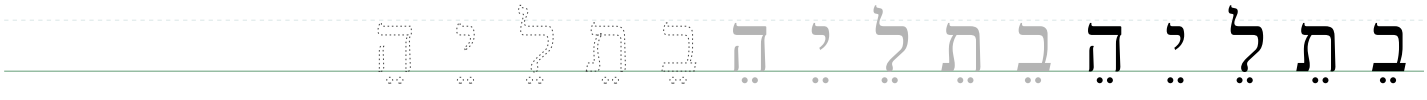
☐ a - kamatz a as in father (short, no glide) [a]



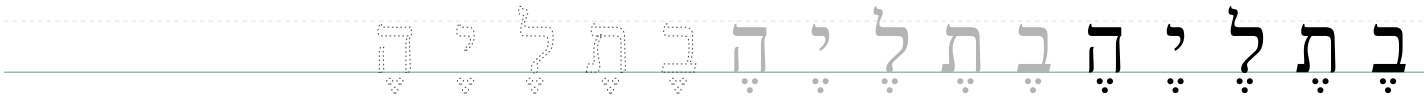
☐ a - patach a as in father [a]



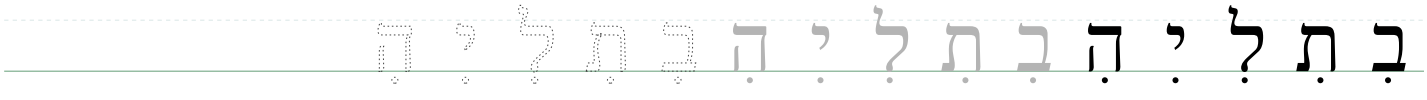
☐ e - tzere e as in bed (a few words and speakers say ei as in they) [ę]



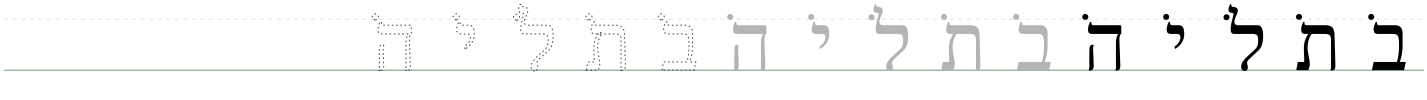
☐ e - segol e as in bed [ę]



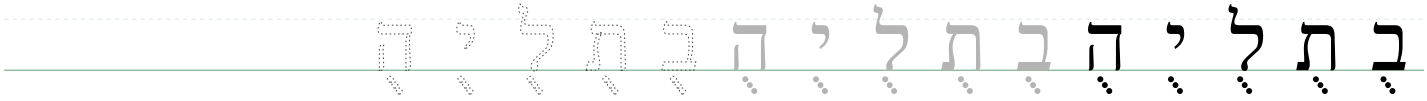
☐ i - chirik i as in machine (short) [i]



☐ o - cholam o as in for (no glide) [o̧]



☐ u - kubutz oo as in boot (short) [u]



☐ u - shuruk oo as in boot [u]



Copy the word, then write it again in the blank space. Write how it sounds on the last line.

☐ **1** he returned

שָׁב 

sounds like: _____

☐ **2** Sabbath

שַׁבָּת 

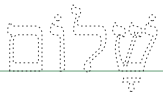
sounds like: _____

☐ **3** daughter

בַּת 

sounds like: _____

☐ **4** peace; hello

שָׁלוֹם 

sounds like: _____

☐ **5** to him

לוֹ 

sounds like: _____

☐ **6** in me

בִּי 

sounds like: _____

☐ **7** to me

לִי 

sounds like: _____

☐ **8** dad

אַבָּא 

sounds like: _____

☐ **9** he came

בָּא 

sounds like: _____

☐ **10** he was

הָיָה 

sounds like: _____

☐ **11** no; not

לֹא 

sounds like: _____

☐ **12** God

אֵל 

sounds like: _____

☐ **13** house of

בֵּית 

sounds like: _____

☐ **14** heart

לֵב 

sounds like: _____

☐ **15** song

שִׁיר 

sounds like: _____

☐ **16** mom

אִמָּא 

sounds like: _____

☐ **17** head

רֹאשׁ 

sounds like: _____

☐ **18** high

רָם 

sounds like: _____

☐ **19** because

כִּי 

sounds like: _____

☐ **20** to you

לָךְ 

sounds like: _____

☐ **21** you (m.)

אַתָּה 

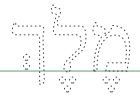
sounds like: _____

☐ **22** (object marker)

אֶת 

sounds like: _____

☐ **23** king

מֶלֶךְ 

sounds like: _____

☐ **24** son

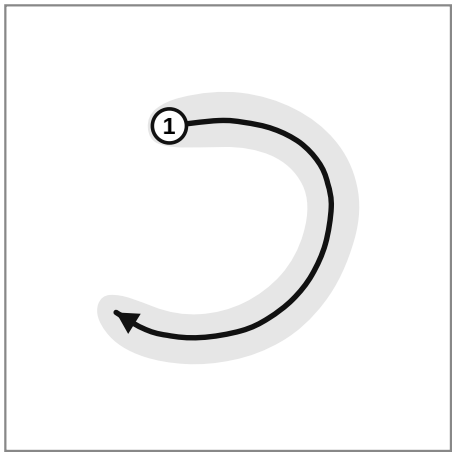
בֵּן 

sounds like: _____

Letters 10-18: Resh, Mem, Kaf, Final Kaf, Nun, Final Nun, Pe, Final Pe, Chet

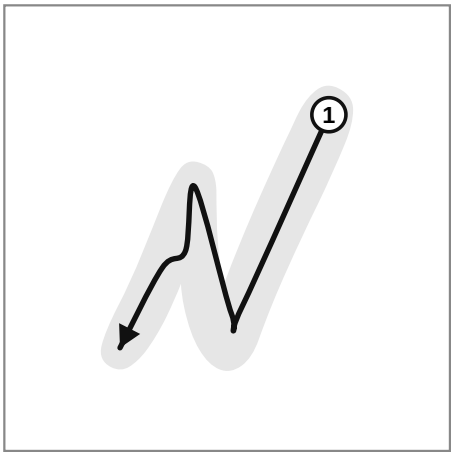
Circle with a number = where each stroke starts; arrowhead = where it ends. **Draft order, not teacher-reviewed.**

Kaf



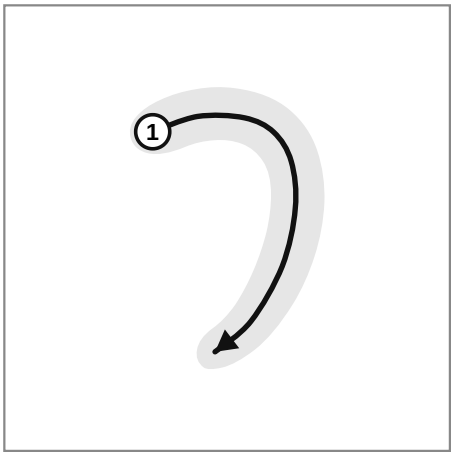
1 stroke

Mem



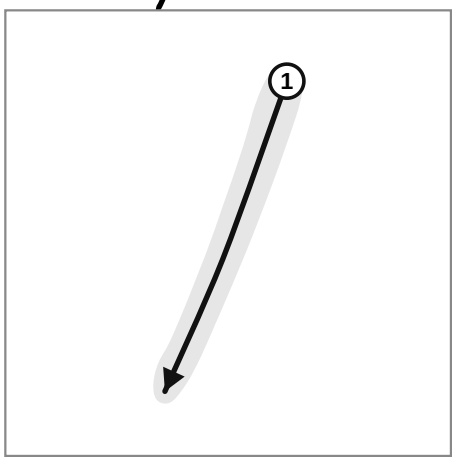
1 stroke

Resh



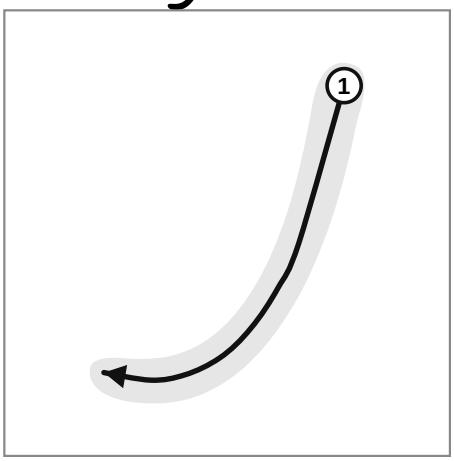
1 stroke

Nun sofit



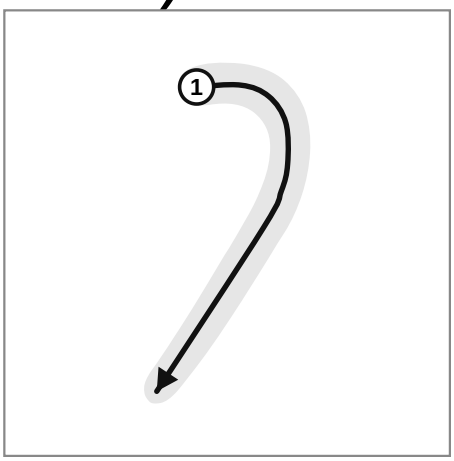
1 stroke

Nun



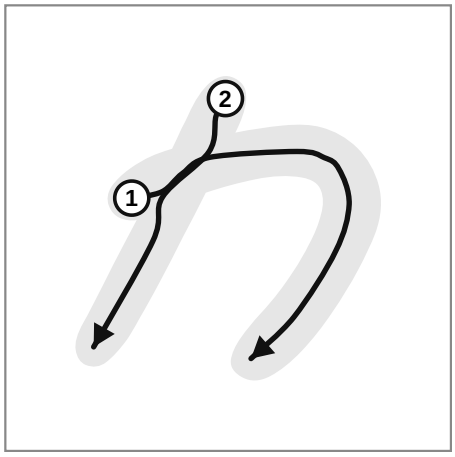
1 stroke

Kaf sofit



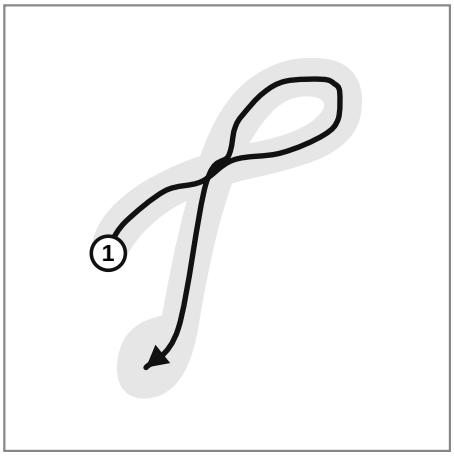
1 stroke

Chet



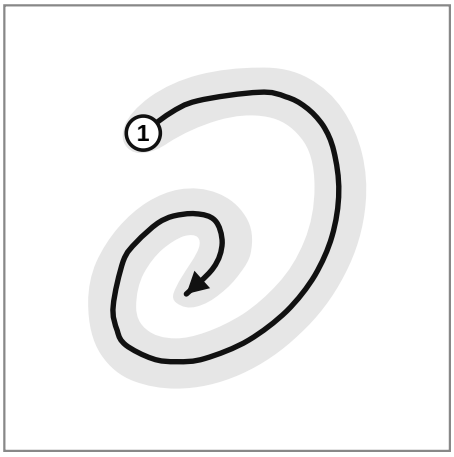
2 strokes

Pe sofit



1 stroke

Pe



1 stroke

☐ **10** Resh (200) *a Round head from the side, no corner: Rrr (rosh = head)* /ʁ/



☐ **11** Mem (40) *a Mountain tent, flap open: Mmm (final mem = zipped shut)* /m/



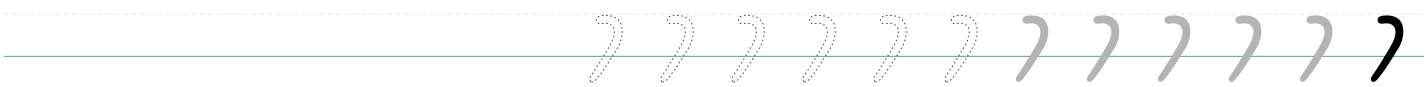
☐ **12** Kaf (20) *a Kitchen spoon with a Kernel (dot): K; empty = Kh* /k/



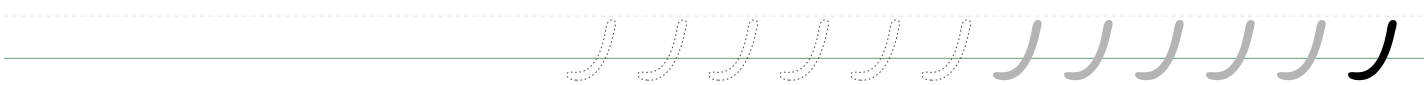
☐ **12b** Khaf (20) *Kaf's spoon, empty, blown on: Khhh* /χ/



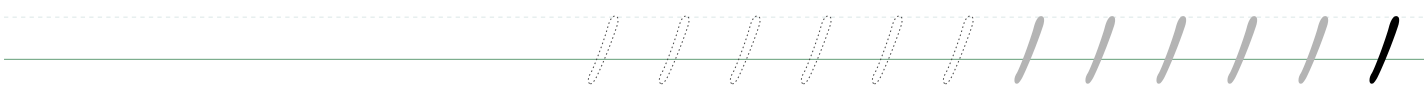
☐ **13** Kaf sofit (500*) *a King's cloak trailing on the floor: kh at word end* /k ~ χ/



☐ **14** Nun (50) *a cat Napping curled in a box; final nun stands straight* /n/



☐ **15** Nun sofit (700*) *a Nail standing straight, below the line: n* /n/



☐ **16** Pe (80) *a mouth that Pops (dot) or Fluffs (no dot): P or F* /p/



☐ **16b** Fe (80) *Pe without the pop: a Feather floating, F* /f/



☐ **17** Pe sofit (800*) *a mouth with its tongue lolling out below the line: ƒ* /p ~ f/



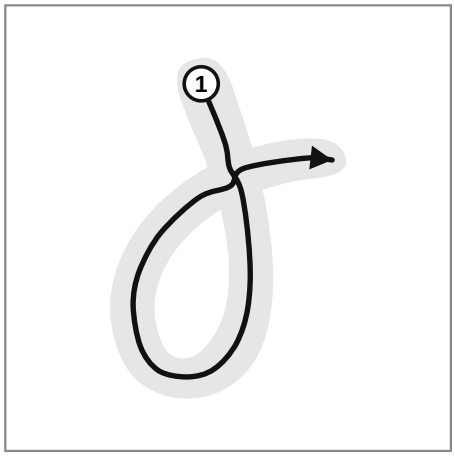
☐ **18** Chet (8) *a Closed gate, a cat hissing Chhh (Chanukah)* /χ/



Letters 19-27: Dalet, Gimel, Ayin, Samekh, Zayin, Tet, Tsadi, Final Tsadi, Qof

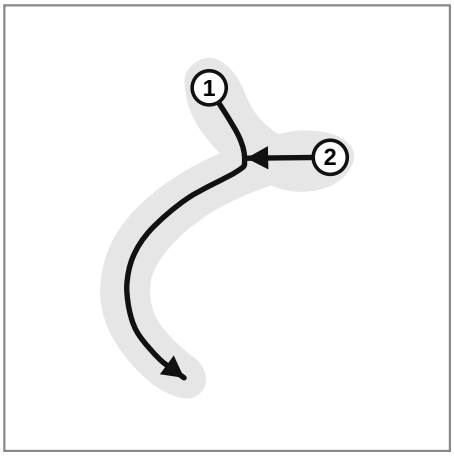
Circle with a number = where each stroke starts; arrowhead = where it ends. **Draft order, not teacher-reviewed.**

Ayin



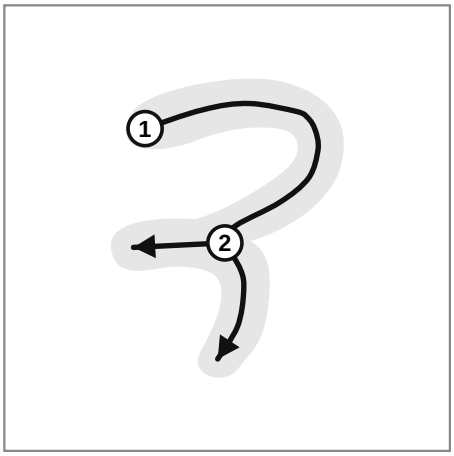
1 stroke

Gimel



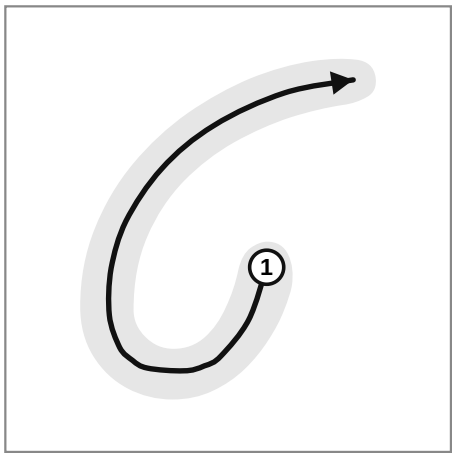
2 strokes

Dalet



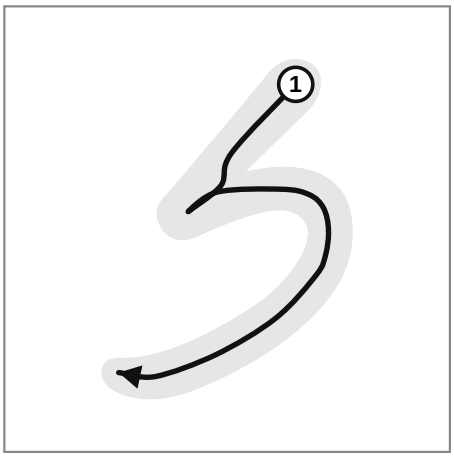
2 strokes

Tet



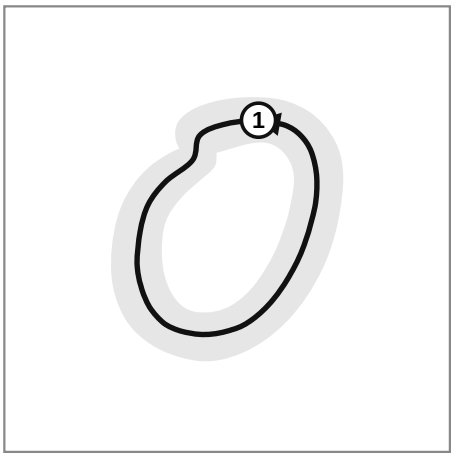
1 stroke

Zayin



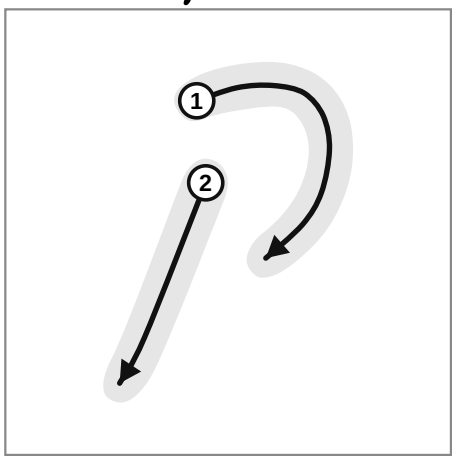
1 stroke

Samekh



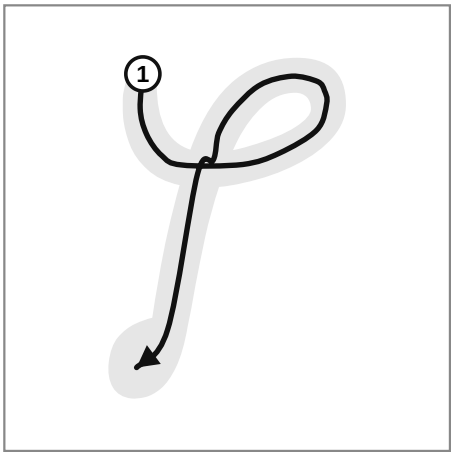
1 stroke

Qof



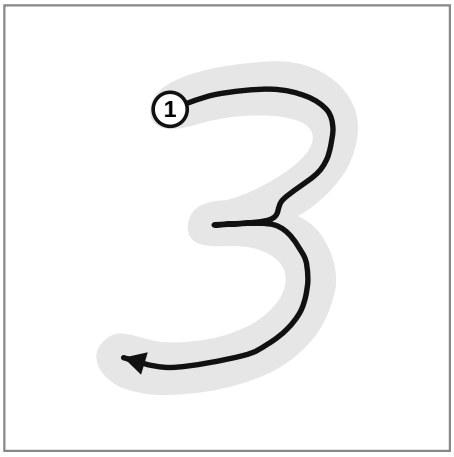
2 strokes

Tsadi sofit



1 stroke

Tsadi



1 stroke

☐ **19** Dalet (4) *a Diving board on one post: D (a Door frame from the side)* /d/



☐ **20** Gimel (3) *a Grumpy camel on the Go, one foot kicked out* /g/



☐ **21** Ayin (70) *an Eye winking in silence; you only hear the vowel* /ʔ/



☐ **22** Samekh (60) *a Soft cushion you Sit on: Sss (round, no sharp corners)* /s/



☐ **23** Zayin (7) *a Zipper pull: a bar on top, zzzip* /z/



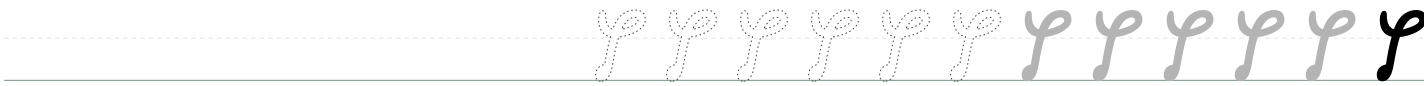
☐ **24** Tet (9) *a round-bellied Teapot full of Tea: T* /t/



☐ **25** Tsadi (90) *a sitting Cat with pointed ears, by a pizza: ts* /ts/



☐ **26** Tsadi sofit (900*) *a Tree: Y branches, long trunk into the land: ts* /ts/



☐ **27** Qof (100) *a Kite with its string hanging below the line: K* /k/

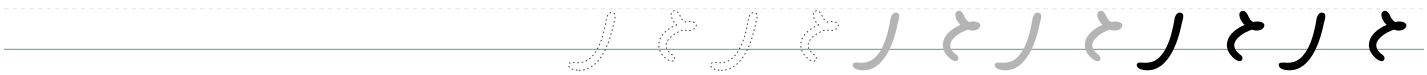


Letters that are easy to mix up. Trace a whole set in a row, then write the set from memory.

☐ Bet / Kaf / Pe — Bet's base sticks out to the right past the back; kaf is a single curved stroke like a reversed c; pe has a curl inside.



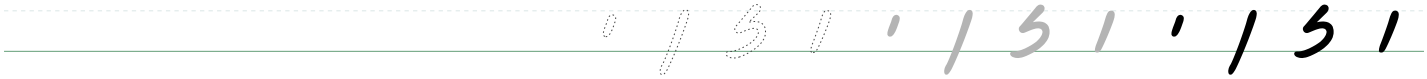
☐ Gimel / Nun — Gimel has a foot at the bottom left; nun has a flat base and no foot.



☐ Dalet / Resh / Kaf sofit — Dalet has a sharp corner and its top bar sticks out past the stem; resh is one rounded curve; final kaf is a resh with a long tail.



☐ Vav / Zayin / Nun sofit / Yod — Vav is a plain single stroke; zayin has a bar that sticks out to the right at the top; final nun is an extra-long vav that drops below the line; yod is short and floats at the top.



☐ He / Chet / Tav — He has a gap (window) at the upper left; chet is closed; tav has a foot that points left.



☐ Samekh / Mem sofit — Samekh is rounded; final mem is square.



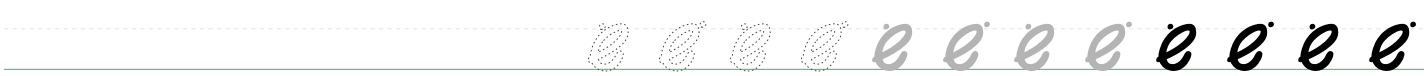
☐ Tsadi / Ayin — Tsadi's second stroke comes from the top right; ayin's second stroke comes from the top left.



☐ Pe sofit / Tsadi sofit — Final pe curls inward at the top left; final tsadi forks upward like a Y.



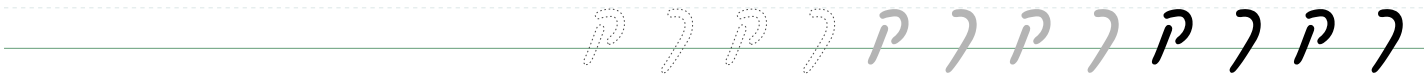
☐ Shin / Sin — Shin has its dot on the upper right (sh); sin has its dot on the upper left (s). Dots are often left off in handwriting.



☐ Dalet / Resh — Rapid cursive dalet and resh look alike; dalet leans and is angled.



☐ Kaf sofit / Qof Final kaf and qof transformed alike in cursive; qof has a descender at the left.



☐ Shin / Tsadi Shin's central stroke was lengthened like tsadi's right arm.

